



PRAMOD SHARMA

✓ OPEN HOUSE

ARJUN VALLURI spent a little extra on his clever home, but he's not complaining

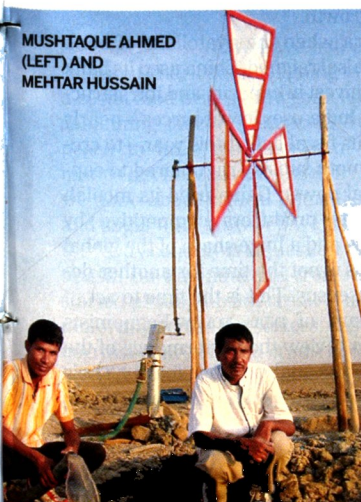
His is a green home with a platinum rating. Located in a valley in a rocky terrain of Hyderabad, about 30 per cent of the site is natural landscape. Inside the house are fresh air systems and double glazed glass for conditioned areas, a hydraulic lift, CFLs for lighting, extensive bamboo flooring and natural woollen carpets in rooms. Valluri sparked the idea that he got while heading the Intelli Group, a US-based IT company, of which he was a founder. With no water charges and monthly electricity bills of Rs 4,000 as against Rs 25,000-30,000 for comparable houses, Valluri says he will make good the five per cent extra expense for green features in just about five years.

by Amarnath K. Menon



ARJUN VALLURI'S GREEN HOUSE

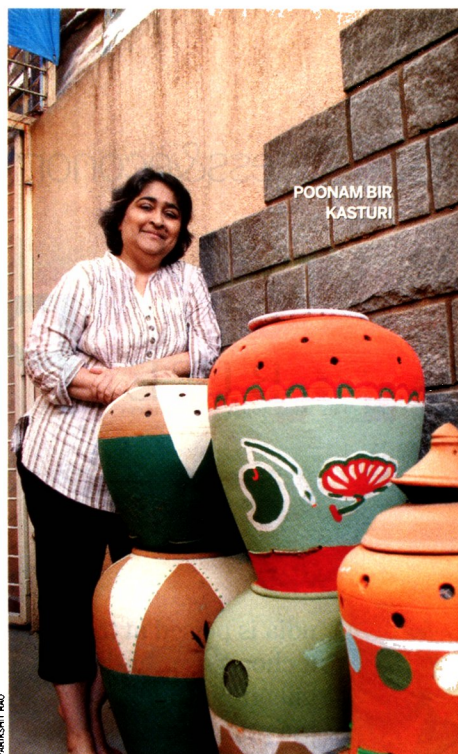
A PRADHAN RAO www.indiatodayimages.com



MUSHTAQUE AHMED (LEFT) AND MEHTAR HUSSAIN

workers of the Little Rann of Kutch. Thanks to the windmill that helps families to draw water from the wells for their salt pan in place of a diesel pump, the annual diesel bill of Rs 75,000 for each family has now gone down to almost half. Costing Rs 30,000, the duo provided four blades in the low height device and attached it to two poles. The simple cylinder that one finds in a normal hand pump works here as a water lifter when the blades rotate due to wind. Last year, six such windmills were installed on an experimental basis in the salt desert of the Little Rann.

by Uday Mahurkar



POONAM BIR KASTURI

^ CALM AND COMPOST

POONAM BIR KASTURI shows not just how to dump wet waste the right way. She makes good money from it too.

Kasturi hates garbage. And rather than crib about the mess on the streets, she decided to fight the system by combating it in a novel way. An industrial designer by training and entrepreneur by choice, Kasturi set up Daily Dump in 2006 as a comprehensive retail solution in waste management. The company sells rather interesting composting pots where a household's wet waste can be composted. All you need is a pot, some sawdust, dry leaves or shredded newspapers. Coupled with these ingredients, your waste is well on its way to becoming manure. The first harvest takes two months, but after that every 15 days expect your garbage to turn into manure. Once your compost is ready, you can sell it back to Daily Dump. For homes which generate more garbage than the terracotta pots can accommodate, Daily Dump also offers to set up a community composting corners in buildings and societies. And what's more, it is not only self-sustaining but proving to be profitable as well.

by Malini Bhupta